Power from the Sun: Australia's Energy Shift

NAPLAN-Style Informational Reading Worksheet

Year 6 English | ACARA: AC9E6LY03 | AC9E6LY05 | AC9E6LY06

Name: ________________________ Date: ________________________ Score: _____ / 20

Learning Intention: I can analyse an informational text, infer meaning, evaluate evidence and justify my answers using details from the passage.

Reading Strategy **Read like a detective - underline facts, circle key words and use evidence.**

Reading Passage

Across Australia, the way people produce and use electricity is changing. For many years, much of the nation's power came from fossil fuels such as coal and gas. These sources can produce large amounts of electricity, but they also release greenhouse gases when burned. As communities become more aware of climate change, many Australians are looking for cleaner ways to power homes, schools and businesses.

Renewable energy comes from sources that can naturally replace themselves. Solar panels use sunlight, wind turbines use moving air, and hydro systems use flowing water. Australia has strong potential for renewable energy because many regions receive high levels of sunshine and have open spaces where wind can be captured. On some rooftops, solar panels already turn everyday sunlight into electricity for families.

However, the energy transition is not as simple as replacing one power station with another. Solar panels do not produce electricity at night, and wind turbines depend on weather conditions. This means energy storage is important. Batteries can store electricity for later use, while pumped hydro systems move water to a higher place and release it when power is needed.

Engineers and planners also need to think about power lines, costs and reliability. A school, hospital or train network needs electricity when it is required, not only when the sun is shining. For this reason, many experts believe Australia's future energy system will use a mix of technologies rather than one single solution.

Communities are part of the change too. Some towns are creating local energy projects, while families reduce electricity use by choosing efficient appliances, turning off unused devices and improving home insulation. These actions may seem small, but together they can reduce pressure on the energy system.

The shift to renewable energy is both a challenge and an opportunity. It requires investment, new skills and careful planning. It also creates jobs in areas such as engineering, construction, science and technology. If Australia manages the transition wisely, cleaner energy could help protect the environment while still supporting the daily lives of millions of people.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Answer from easy to hard. Use evidence from the passage where needed.

Section A **Multiple choice**

1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

☐ To entertain with a fictional adventure ☐ To explain an issue and possible responses

☐ To list random facts ☐ To persuade readers to avoid all technology

Section B **Find the facts**

2. Identify two facts from the passage that show why the topic matters.

3. Name one person, group or technology involved in solving the problem.

Section C

Vocabulary

4. In the passage, what does 'transition' most nearly mean?

☐ A change from one thing to another ☐ A type of animal

☐ A short holiday ☐ A broken machine

Author's Purpose

5. Why did the author include specific examples or data in the passage?

Section D **Inference**

6. What can you infer about why no single energy source is presented as perfect?

7. Write one question you still have after reading this text.

☐ Evidence used ☐ Key vocabulary ☐ Clear opinion ☐ Capital letters & full stops

☐ Answer checked

High Five! You're a Reading Comprehension Superstar!

☐ Vocabulary ☐ Inference ☐ Evidence Response - All done = Reader Award in Pet Town!

Teacher / Parent Feedback

Well done for...

Next step...

Star Rating: ☆☆☆☆☆

Teacher & Parent Guide

Power from the Sun: Australia's Energy Shift - Year 6 Reading

Curriculum Alignment - ACARA v9.0

AC9E6LY03 - Analyse how text structures and language features work together to meet the purpose of a text.
AC9E6LY05 - Use comprehension strategies to interpret and analyse information and ideas.
AC9E6LY06 - Create written responses using evidence from texts.

Answer Key & Sample Responses

Question	Expected Response / Marking Guide	Marks
1	To explain Australia's shift towards renewable energy and the challenges involved.	2
2	Accept facts about greenhouse gases, solar/wind potential, storage, reliability or jobs.	4
3	Engineers, planners, families, towns, batteries, solar panels, wind turbines or hydro systems.	2
4	Transition means a change from one thing to another.	1
5	Examples/data help readers understand benefits and challenges in a balanced way.	3
6	Each source has limits, so a mix of technologies is likely needed for reliable power.	4
7	Accept a relevant question about energy, storage, cost, jobs or the environment.	1

Differentiation Strategies

Support / Foundation

- Read passage aloud
- Highlight key words
- Answer Sections A-B
- Use sentence frames

At Level / Year 6

- Complete all sections
- Use evidence
- Explain vocabulary
- Self-check answers

Extension / Advanced

- Compare with another text
- Research a real example
- Write a balanced response
- Create an infographic

Fun Aussie Activities at Home

Energy Hunt

List five things at home that use electricity.

Sun Check

Observe where sunlight reaches your home during the day.

Family Challenge

Choose one way to reduce electricity use this week.

Design Task

Draw a future school powered by clean energy.